

The Tides Forget

— Verse 1 —

Calypso tide upon the shore she walked

Her hair was salt her eyes were green

She kept a song the deep had taught

And wore the night like quiet thread

She drew the moon above her crown

And placed the stars upon her sleeve

She walked the foam where Davy slept

And whispered to the wreath of weeds

The Tides Forget

— Verse 2 —

There once was love between two restless ghosts

Beneath the chart the dead men drew

Salt was their bridal feast and brine their wine

Calypso braided foam through Davy's hair

And taught him how to sleep in tides

He gave her one small wooden seabird carved

She gave him every wreck and broken keel

That ever sank inside the deep

The Tides Forget

— Verse 3 —

The shanties Davy crew once sang
Were taught by deep sea mothers long ago
Calypso whispered to their cradles
So the songs would find their way to him
And every bell that ever tolled
Was an echo of her grief
And every wave that crested high
Came down again to softly sing his name

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— Verse 4 —

She told the dolphins how to mourn

She taught the krakens how to weep

She spoke to every storm that broke

Each wave became a kind of letter

Each tide a paragraph she wrote

But none would carry to her love

Down in the locker dark below

Where Davy held his frozen breath

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— Verse 5 —

She tried a coral shell a song
A stitched up gull a knot of weed
But every gift she sent below
Returned by morning to her hands
Refused by waters of her own
And so she chose another way to hold
Her words for him a little longer
Until a living hand should find them

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— Verse 6 —

Hear the soft bell calling far away

She buried her great farewell three ways

Inside a sealed and salt stained box

Inside a song the wind has taught

Inside the sound the ocean makes

When breaking white against a shore

And only one alive who finds

The seam between the three may pull it free